

TIMELINE

September 15, 1914 Born in Springfield, Massachusetts, the son of a repairman for Boston & Albany Railroad.

1936 Graduates from West Point and marries Julia Harvey.

1936–40 Serves as lieutenant and captain in First Cavalry Division.

1938 Birth of Noel, the first of six children. The three sons become army officers, and the three daughters marry army officers.

1940 Serves as tank company commander in First Armored Division.

1941–43 Becomes a lieutenant colonel and commands the 37th Tank Battalion, Fourth Armored Division, Third Army, under General George S. Patton.

September 1944 Leads Combat Command B in the Battle of the Bulge.

1945 Receives field promotion to colonel.



ABRAMS IN THE TURRET OF A TANK, 1945

1949–52 Commands 63rd Tank Battalion and Second Armored Cavalry Regiment.

1953–54 Serves as chief of staff for three corps commands in Korea.

1956 Promoted to brigadier general and serves as deputy chief of staff for reserve components.

1959 Promoted to rank of major general and becomes commander of the Third Armored Division.

1962 Transferred to the Pentagon as deputy chief of staff for operations.

1963 Appointed lieutenant general and commands V Corps in Europe.

1964 Promoted to general and named vice chief of staff.

May 1967 Named deputy commander of Military Assistance Command Vietnam (MACV). Becomes commander the following year.

June 1972 Appointed chief of staff of the US Army.

September 4, 1974 Dies of lung cancer in Washington, D.C.